RoCo-Spring: The Robust Correspondence Challenge

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Abstract

Dense correspondence has made remarkable progress on standard benchmarks, with modern optical flow, stereo matching, and scene flow methods achieving increasingly strong i.i.d. performance. However, this progress still does not translate reliably to real-world deployment, where camera noise, adverse weather, blur, compression, and illumination changes can substantially degrade performance in safety-critical settings such as autonomous driving, robotics, augmented reality, and scientific imaging. **RoCo-Spring**, short for **Robust Correspondence on Spring**, targets this gap between clean benchmark accuracy and robustness under realistic distribution shifts. The competition uses the Spring and RobustSpring benchmark because they provide a particularly well-suited foundation for this question: high-resolution, high-detail scenes; dense ground truth for optical flow, stereo, and scene flow; and paired clean and corrupted evaluations in which the corruptions remain time-, stereo-, and depth-consistent. This makes it possible to measure robustness without conflating it with unrelated changes in scene content, annotation quality, or benchmark protocol. Participants will compete on three quantitative leaderboards: optical flow, stereo matching, and scene flow, using a balanced score that jointly rewards low error on Spring and RobustSpring. Each entry will also submit a 4-6 page single-blind workshop paper that describes the method, training data, compute, and evidence behind the submission. A fourth exploration track will reward rigorous studies of why current methods fail or succeed under robustness evaluation. The starting kit will provide PTLFlow-based training, evaluation, packaging, and submission scripts, together with baseline results from Spring and RobustSpring. The expected outcome is a worldwide, reproducible effort to move dense correspondence beyond clean benchmark accuracy toward methods that remain accurate under realistic deployment conditions.

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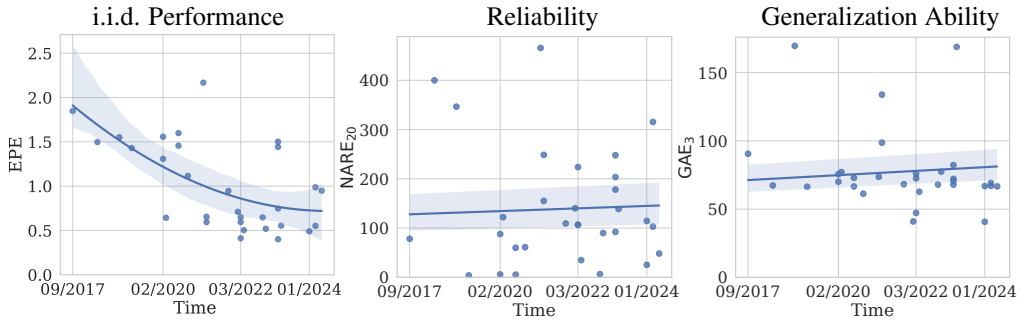


Figure 1: Motivation from FlowBench (Agnihotri et al., 2025), showing errors, thus, lower is better. Optical flow methods have improved on i.i.d. error over time, while reliability under attacks and out-of-distribution generalization ability have remained comparatively stagnant. RoCo-Spring asks the community to optimize for both clean accuracy and robustness.

Keywords Robustness, optical flow, stereo matching, scene flow, distribution shift.

1 Competition description

1.1 Background and impact

Dense correspondence is a foundation of visual perception. Optical flow computes 2D motion, stereo matching estimates depth, and scene flow combines geometry and motion in dynamic 3D scenes. These tasks support applications in autonomous driving, robotics, augmented and virtual reality, video editing, scientific imaging, and medical imaging. While the community has made impressive progress on clean benchmarks, real systems must also handle blur, noise, compression, illumination changes, motion artifacts, and adverse weather.

This gap is no longer anecdotal. FlowBench (Agnihotri et al., 2025) shows that optical flow methods have improved on i.i.d. test data, while reliability and out-of-distribution generalization remain comparatively stagnant (see Fig. 1). RobustSpring (Oei et al., 2026) shows that modern methods can be highly sensitive to realistic corruptions, with failures varying across corruption types and model families. RoCo-Spring turns this evidence into a community challenge: clean accuracy remains important, but it is no longer sufficient. The competition asks whether dense correspondence methods can preserve strong i.i.d. performance while becoming less brittle under realistic visual shifts.

The choice of Spring and RobustSpring is driven by the scientific question, not by dataset ownership. A robustness competition for dense correspondence needs accurate dense ground truth, high-resolution scenes with fine structures, multiple correspondence tasks, and paired clean and corrupted evaluation. Spring (Mehl et al., 2023b) provides high-resolution, high-detail rendered data with dense ground truth for optical flow, stereo, and scene flow. RobustSpring (Oei et al., 2026) extends the same scenes with realistic corruptions that remain consistent over time, between stereo views, and with the underlying depth structure. This pairing isolates corruption sensitivity from confounders such as different scene content, cameras, annotation protocols, or dataset sources. RoCo-Spring is therefore a focused, reproducible, and globally accessible NeurIPS competition on robustness, distribution shift, and model design for structured correspondence prediction.

1.2 Related workshops and challenges

RoCo-Spring builds on a long line of community efforts around optical flow, stereo, scene flow, and robust vision. The ECCV 2012 Workshop on Unsolved Problems in Optical Flow and Stereo Estimation (Kondermann et al., 2012a) and the associated Robust Vision Challenge (Kondermann et al., 2012b) highlighted the need to evaluate dense correspondence beyond idealized settings. Later Robust Vision Challenge editions, including CVPR 2018 (Geiger et al., 2018), ECCV 2020 (Zendel et al., 2020), and ECCV 2022 (Zendel et al., 2022), broadened this view to multiple vision tasks, including optical flow and stereo, and encouraged methods that perform well across several established benchmarks.

RoCo-Spring is complementary but distinct. Earlier Robust Vision Challenges primarily tested cross-benchmark performance: methods were evaluated across datasets that may differ in scenes, sensors, domains, annotation protocols, and difficulty, and participants could often train or fine-tune on data from the corresponding benchmark domains. This is valuable for measuring multi-domain performance, but it does not isolate the out-of-distribution robustness question that is crucial for real-world deployment: when the scene, ground truth, and task protocol are fixed, how much does a method degrade under realistic visual corruptions?

Spring (Mehl et al., 2023b) and RobustSpring (Oei et al., 2026) make this controlled question possible. They provide high-resolution, high-detail scenes with dense ground truth for optical flow, stereo, and scene flow, together with paired clean and corrupted evaluations in which corruptions remain time-, stereo-, and depth-consistent. RoCo-Spring therefore measures robustness without conflating it with unrelated changes in scene content, annotation quality, or benchmark protocol. Building on the broader concern raised by the ECCV 2018 workshop "What Is Optical Flow For?" (Güney et al., 2018), RoCo-Spring turns robust dense correspondence into a concrete competition objective for current architectures, including cost-volume, recurrent, transformer-based, multi-frame, augmentation-based, and adaptation-based methods. The timing is ideal: strong methods, open-source infrastructure, public baselines, and a benchmark family that jointly measures clean and corrupted performance are now available.

1.3 Novelty

RoCo-Spring is a new competition with a clear scientific target: improving dense correspondence robustness without sacrificing clean benchmark accuracy. It is grounded in Spring, RobustSpring, and FlowBench, but the contribution is the protocol, incentive structure, and community organization around robustness as the primary objective.

The novelty is threefold. First, optical flow, stereo matching, and scene flow are evaluated in one consistent benchmark family, enabling both task-specific and cross-task robustness analysis. Second, the leaderboards use a clean-plus-corrupted score, so a method cannot win by optimizing only i.i.d. performance or by improving corrupted performance while collapsing on clean data. Third, the exploration track rewards scientific analysis, not only leaderboard optimization, because robustness failures may arise from architecture choices, cost volumes, training objectives, pretraining data, augmentation, temporal consistency, uncertainty calibration, or evaluation design. RoCo-Spring follows the successful structure of prior NeurIPS competitions, with public starting kits, standardized data, transparent rules, leaderboards, reproducibility checks, and an in-person workshop.

1.4 Data

The competition uses Spring and RobustSpring because their combination is unusually well matched to the robustness question. Spring provides high-resolution, high-detail rendered scenes with dense ground truth for optical flow, stereo, and scene flow (Mehl et al., 2023b). This is important because correspondence failures often occur around fine structures, occlusion boundaries, thin objects, specular regions, large displacements, and detailed motion patterns. RobustSpring extends Spring with 20 realistic corruptions, including noise, blur, color changes, quality degradations, and weather distortions (Oei et al., 2026). The corruptions are generated consistently across time, stereo views, and depth, avoiding artificial temporal or stereo inconsistencies that could make the evaluation less meaningful.

This design provides three advantages. Participants can compare clean and corrupted performance within the same benchmark family; held-out evaluation can quantify degradation from a clean reference rather than performance on an unrelated dataset; and one data family supports optical flow, stereo, and scene flow, enabling cross-task analysis. These properties make Spring and RobustSpring a strong choice for improving robust dense correspondence, rather than merely promoting a dataset.

The competition will use existing public training material and a held-out benchmark evaluation. Test ground truth remains private and is used only by the evaluation server. Participants submit predictions, not labels. The benchmark will report task-specific Spring and RobustSpring errors, aggregated into the score in Section 1.6. The data are rendered from computer-generated scenes and do not contain private personal information, but participants must respect dataset licenses, benchmark terms, and the NeurIPS Code of Conduct and Code of Ethics. Feature leakage is addressed through private labels,

submission limits, a separated development and final phase, server-side validation, and reproducibility checks. External public data are allowed only if declared, and such entries will be flagged separately.

1.5 Tasks and application scenarios

The competition has three quantitative task leaderboards and one exploration leaderboard.

Optical flow. Participants estimate dense 2D motion between consecutive frames. This task is central to video perception under camera motion, dynamic scenes, autonomous navigation, tracking, video stabilization, and robotic interaction.

Stereo matching. Participants estimate disparity from rectified stereo pairs. This task supports depth estimation for robotics, autonomous driving, augmented reality, and industrial inspection.

Scene flow. Participants estimate 3D motion from stereo video. This task combines geometry and motion and is directly relevant for dynamic 3D scene understanding.

Exploration track. Participants submit an exploratory paper, code, and evidence around a focused robustness question. Suggested directions include pitfalls of current robustness evaluations; the role of cost volumes in robustness, especially in light of recent work that removes cost volumes from optical flow estimators (Kiefhaber et al., 2025); iterative residual refinement; recurrent refinement, global matching, transformers, and multi-frame cues; augmentation and synthetic-to-real transfer; corruption-specific failure taxonomies; uncertainty and calibration; test-time adaptation without test-label leakage; temporal consistency; efficiency-robustness trade-offs; and whether robustness gains transfer across optical flow, stereo, and scene flow.

The tasks are challenging but feasible. The starting kit will provide training, evaluation, and submission scripts, and baseline results already exist in the Spring and RobustSpring papers. The challenge is therefore not to build an evaluation pipeline from scratch, but to propose a new method, improve existing methods, or produce careful scientific insight under a controlled protocol.

1.6 Metrics

Each quantitative task uses the official endpoint-error-style metric for that task. Let $E_S^t(m)$ denote the error of method m on Spring for task t, and let $E_R^t(m)$ denote its average error on RobustSpring across the corruptions in the evaluation split. Lower values are better. Directly adding raw errors would be inappropriate because clean and corrupted errors can have different scales, and the scales also differ across optical flow, stereo, and scene flow. We therefore use a normalized balanced score:

$$\text{RbS-Score}^t(m) = \frac{1}{2}\frac{E_S^t(m)}{B_S^t} + \frac{1}{2}\frac{E_R^t(m)}{B_R^t}, \tag{1}$$

where B_S^t and B_R^t are fixed before launch as the median Spring and RobustSpring errors of a published baseline set for task t. The baseline set will be drawn from the methods reported in Spring and RobustSpring and released with the starting kit. This score is simple, transparent, and robust to scale differences: each term is a relative error against a fixed reference scale, and clean and corrupted performance receive equal weight. A method cannot win by optimizing only the clean benchmark, and it also cannot win by improving corrupted performance while collapsing on clean data.

Ties will be broken by the normalized RobustSpring term, then by the normalized Spring term, because the core scientific question is robustness under distribution shift while retaining standard accuracy. The overall cross-task leaderboard will average the three task scores for teams submitting to all quantitative tasks, while single-task participation remains possible. The workshop report will also publish Spring error, RobustSpring error, corruption-wise errors, relative robustness ratios, effective robustness for optical flow where applicable, and paired-bootstrap uncertainty. Results within a small confidence interval will be marked as statistically indistinguishable.

The exploration track will be judged by an organizer-appointed committee using four equally weighted criteria: clarity of the scientific question, rigor of the experimental protocol, reproducibility of the evidence, and usefulness for future robust dense correspondence research.

1.7 Baselines, code, and material provided

The starting kit will be released within two weeks of acceptance. It will include data download instructions, PTLFlow-based training and inference scripts, wrappers for selected optical flow baselines, submission packaging scripts, local format validation, RobustSpring evaluation helpers for public development data, and example submissions. It will also include baseline tables from Spring and RobustSpring. The modified PTLFlow branch will provide Spring and RobustSpring data loaders, standard configs, prediction export scripts, archive-name checks for `_team_<unique_ID>_RbSCW`, and a minimal baseline that can be trained or evaluated with modest GPU resources. This lets smaller groups start quickly while allowing larger teams to explore more ambitious architectures.

1.8 Website, tutorial and documentation

The competition website will be online within two weeks of acceptance. It will include task definitions, timeline, data instructions, rules, FAQ, leaderboard links, starting kit, tutorial notebooks, baseline tables, submission templates, and a contact email. A public GitHub repository will handle issues and code updates. Tutorial material will cover data download, baseline execution, local validation, benchmark submission, and metric interpretation.

2 Organizational aspects

2.1 Protocol

Participants will register a team and receive a unique team ID, download the data and starting kit, train or adapt a method, generate predictions, validate the archive locally, and submit predictions to the benchmark server. Submission file names must end with `_team_<unique_ID>_RbSCW`. The server will compute Spring and RobustSpring errors and update the public leaderboard during development. The final phase will use frozen submissions and hidden labels. Each quantitative or exploration entry will also submit a 4–6 page workshop paper that describes the method, training data, compute budget, evaluation findings, and limitations. Exploration-track teams will submit their paper together with code and reproduction instructions.

Cheating and overfitting will be mitigated through private labels, submission limits, a frozen final phase, server-side validation, and reproducibility packages for award candidates. Manual editing of test predictions, use of non-public labels, reverse engineering hidden labels, and multiple team aliases are prohibited. Top quantitative entries must provide a method description, training-data declaration, compute declaration, and code or an executable environment for organizer-side checks. Fairness is further supported by a common starting kit, public baselines, transparent external-data rules, and separate reporting of single-task and cross-task results.

2.2 Workshop papers and review process

Each submitted entry must be accompanied by a 4–6 page workshop paper. The paper will explain the technical contribution, implementation details, training and pretraining data, compute usage, leaderboard results, ablations, and reproducibility material. Papers will be reviewed single blind. Double-blind review is not appropriate here because the challenge has an open public leaderboard, participants submit under team IDs, and authorship can often be inferred from public submissions, repositories, or benchmark entries. Single-blind review is therefore the fairest, most transparent choice: reviewers know the authors, but the review criteria remain fixed, task-specific, and evidence-based.

Papers will be reviewed by the organizers and additional external reviewers with expertise in optical flow, stereo, scene flow, robustness, and benchmark design. Acceptance will depend on technical soundness, clarity, reproducibility, and relevance to robust dense correspondence, not only on leaderboard rank. All accepted papers would be forwarded for the official PMLR volume of NeurIPS workshop proceedings. Award eligibility requires an accepted workshop paper and a reproducibility package. This ensures that RoCo-Spring rewards both strong benchmark performance and scientifically useful insights.

Table 1: Tentative competition timeline.

Date	Milestone
June 15, 2026	Acceptance notification and organizer kickoff
June 22, 2026	Website, rules, registration, and FAQ online
June 29, 2026	Starting kit, baseline configs, and practice submissions released
July 13, 2026	Development leaderboard opens for all quantitative tasks
September 15, 2026	4–6 page workshop paper submission deadline
September 29, 2026	Workshop paper author notification
September 30, 2026	Final quantitative submission deadline
October 7, 2026	Camera-ready paper, code, and reproducibility package deadline
October 15, 2026	Final evaluation, reproducibility checks, and award shortlisting
October 31, 2026	Winners notified and workshop program finalized
December 11 or 12, 2026	In-person NeurIPS Competition Track workshop

2.3 Rules and Engagement

Tab. 1 is the tentative competition timeline. The draft contest rules are as follows:

- Each team must register once and use exactly one team ID.
- Each submitted archive must follow the task format and end with `_team_<unique_ID>_RbSCW`.
- The test ground truth is private. Participants must not attempt to infer, reconstruct, scrape, or obtain it.
- All training data, pretraining data, model checkpoints, and external resources must be declared.
- External public data is allowed, but entries using them will be flagged separately in the leaderboard analysis.
- Test-time adaptation is allowed only if it does not use test labels, manual annotation, or information from future leaderboard evaluations.
- Manual per-sample editing of test predictions is not allowed.
- Public leaderboard submissions will be rate limited. Final submissions are frozen after the deadline.
- Award candidates must have an accepted workshop paper and provide a reproducibility package.

These rules support the desired outcome: progress on robust dense correspondence under a fair, reproducible, and scientifically meaningful protocol. Questions will be handled through GitHub issues, a discussion forum, and the dedicated email address. Rule changes will be versioned, dated, and announced to all registered teams.

2.4 Schedule and readiness

At proposal submission, the core scientific and technical ingredients are already in place through Spring, RobustSpring, FlowBench, existing benchmark results, and the planned PTLFlow-based starting kit. The remaining work is straightforward competition packaging: finalizing the website, releasing participant scripts, fixing the public baseline normalization constants, configuring the workshop-paper review workflow, and running a short dry-run before launch.

2.5 Competition promotion and incentives

We will promote the challenge through computer vision and machine learning mailing lists, the Spring and RobustSpring websites, PTLFlow and GitHub channels, social media, university and industry networks, and direct outreach to groups working on optical flow, stereo, scene flow, robustness, autonomous driving, robotics, and 3D perception. The challenge is designed as a worldwide effort:

the team connects Europe, North America, and Asia through the University of Stuttgart, University of Mannheim, MPI-INF, NVIDIA in San Jose, USA, and the University of Science and Technology Beijing. We will invite early-career researchers and groups underrepresented at NeurIPS through clear onboarding material, tutorial sessions, low-barrier baselines, and an exploration track that does not require extensive compute.

Planned incentives include oral presentations, poster slots, public leaderboard visibility, award certificates, and a joint post-competition report. We will seek sponsorship for prizes and student or underrepresented participant travel support.

2.6 Competition track workshop and dissemination

The workshop will emphasize oral talks and discussion. Each contributed talk will be 20 minutes, with 15 minutes for presentation and 5 minutes for questions. The two-hour poster session will support broader interaction with all teams. The closing panel will bring organizers, keynote speakers, and participants together to discuss what worked, what failed, and what the community should do next. Tab. 2 is the tentative schedule for the workshop.

Dissemination will include public leaderboards, a workshop website archive, accepted reports from participants, and an organizer-written post-competition analysis. We plan to submit the post-competition analysis to the PMLR volume dedicated to NeurIPS competitions.

2.7 Keynote speakers

Jia Deng, confirmed keynote speaker. Jia Deng is Professor of Computer Science at Princeton University and Director of the Princeton Vision & Learning Lab. He brings a uniquely relevant perspective to RoCo-Spring: his work spans benchmark-driven computer vision, large-scale datasets such as ImageNet (Deng et al., 2009), and influential dense correspondence architectures across multiple tasks, including RAFT for optical flow (Teed and Deng, 2020), RAFT-Stereo for stereo matching (Lipson et al., 2021), and SEA-RAFT for efficient and accurate optical flow (Wang et al., 2024). His keynote will connect the evolution of correspondence methods and benchmark design with the central question of the challenge: how to turn clean benchmark progress into robust optical flow, stereo, and scene flow methods that remain reliable under realistic visual shifts.

Fatih Porikli, confirmed keynote speaker. Fatih Porikli is an IEEE Fellow and Vice President of Technology at Qualcomm AI Research. His expertise connects robust visual perception, video understanding, low-level vision, and real-world deployment. His prior work includes scene-flow estimation under degraded video conditions, including simultaneous stereo video deblurring and scene flow estimation (Pan et al., 2017), joint stereo video deblurring, scene flow estimation, and moving-object segmentation (Pan et al., 2020), and adversarial robustness for vision systems (Naseer et al., 2020). His talk will provide an industry-facing and deployment-oriented perspective on robust dense correspondence.

We have limited keynote speakers to allow for more talks and discussions from the participants of the challenge, while having keynotes from prominent researchers in the field who have significant works in the direction targeted by our workshop, so that we also obtain their perspective and reasoning for design decisions, and hopefully discussions on negative results that help us understand what did not work and why.

3 Resources

3.1 Organizing team

The organizing team is well matched to RoCo-Spring because its members have directly contributed to the datasets, metrics, methods, robustness evaluations, and software infrastructure that the competition builds on. The team is also international and cross-sector: Jenny Schmalfuss contributes an NVIDIA research perspective from San Jose, USA; Henrique Morimitsu contributes the PTLFlow and optical-flow software perspective from Beijing, China; and the remaining organizers connect European dense correspondence and machine learning groups at the University of Stuttgart, University of Mannheim,

Table 2: Tentative one-day workshop schedule, 8:15 to 17:00.

Time	Session	Format
08:15-08:25	Opening and challenge overview	Organizers
08:25-09:10	Keynote: Jia Deng	35 min talk + 10 min discussion
09:10-09:55	Keynote: Fatih Porikli	35 min talk + 10 min discussion
09:55-10:35	Optical flow track talks	2 talks, 15+5 min each
10:35-11:05	Coffee break	30 min
11:05-11:45	Stereo matching track talks	2 talks, 15+5 min each
11:45-12:25	Scene flow track talks	2 talks, 15+5 min each
12:25-13:25	Lunch	60 min
13:00-15:00	Poster session	2 hours, overlaps with lunch
15:00-15:30	Coffee break	30 min
15:30-16:10	Exploration track talks	2 talks, 15+5 min each
16:10-16:50	Panel and audience forum	Organizers, speakers, teams
16:50-17:00	Awards and closing remarks	Organizers

and MPI-INF. The team spans junior and senior PhD researchers, research scientists, postdoctoral-level researchers, young faculty, and senior professors, giving the challenge both practical execution capacity and senior scientific oversight.

Benchmarking and evaluation metrics. The team has led or co-led Spring (Mehl et al., 2023b), RobustSpring (Oei et al., 2026), FlowBench (Agnihotri et al., 2025), and the effective robustness analysis for optical flow (Bauer et al., 2025). This directly covers the challenge data, robustness motivation, score design, and post-competition analysis.

Open-source correspondence infrastructure. Henrique Morimitsu develops PTLFlow, a PyTorch Lightning-based optical-flow framework that supports training, validation, benchmarking, and model integration (Morimitsu, 2021). This makes the proposed starting kit practical rather than speculative.

Adversarial and corruption robustness. The team has contributed robustness evaluation tools and attacks for dense prediction and motion estimation, including CosPGD (Agnihotri et al., 2024), PCFA (Schmalfuss et al., 2022), and adversarial weather attacks for motion estimation (Schmalfuss et al., 2023). These works give the organizers direct experience with leakage risks, fair attack protocols, robustness metrics, and failure analysis.

Correspondence methods and awards. The organizers and their close research groups have contributed influential dense correspondence methods, including BBPW (Brox et al., 2004), CLG (Bruhn et al., 2005), FlowNet2 (Ilg et al., 2017), ProFlow (Maurer and Bruhn, 2018), MS-RAFT+ (Jahedi et al., 2024b), CCMR (Jahedi et al., 2024a), RPKNet (Morimitsu et al., 2024b), RAPIDFlow (Morimitsu et al., 2024a), DPFlow (Morimitsu et al., 2025), MSGFlow(Valgaerts et al., 2010), M-FUSE (Mehl et al., 2023a), and MS-RAFT-3D (Schmid et al., 2025). This record includes an ECCV 2004 Best Paper Award and a 2014 Koenderink Prize for BBPW, a CVPR 2018 Robust Vision Challenge optical-flow runner-up award for ProFlow and an ECCV 2022 Robust Vision Challenge optical-flow win for MS-RAFT+. Structured biographies are provided in Appendix A.

3.2 Resources provided by organizers

The organizers will provide the website, starting kit, baseline configurations, evaluation instructions, discussion forum, benchmark coordination, and reproducibility checks. Existing Spring and Robust-Spring infrastructure and institutional compute are sufficient for beta testing and baseline validation. Sponsorship is not required, but will be pursued to support prizes and travel grants.

3.3 Support requested

We request inclusion in the in-person NeurIPS 2026 Competition Track, a workshop room with standard AV, poster boards, a schedule slot supporting the planned talks and poster session, website visibility, and platform guidance if needed.

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A Organizers

Shashank Agnihotri, **Doctoral Researcher, University of Mannheim, Germany.**
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Shashank Agnihotri is a Ph.D. candidate in Prof. Dr.-Ing. Margret Keuper's Machine Learning Group at the University of Mannheim. He started his Ph.D work at the Visual Computing Group, University of Siegen under the supervision of Prof. Dr.-Ing. Margret Keuper and moved to University of Mannheim when the group moved. His research focuses on analyzing and improving the reliability, adversarial robustness, and out-of-distribution generalization of deep learning methods, with a particular emphasis on computer vision, dense prediction, and robustness benchmarking. He is the first author of FlowBench, a TMLR 2025 benchmark study on the reliability and generalization of optical flow estimation methods, which directly motivates the scientific goals of RoCo-Spring.

Before joining the University of Mannheim, he worked as a Research Assistant in the Machine Learning Group at Albert-Ludwigs-Universität Freiburg with Prof. Dr. Frank Hutter and Dr. Mahmoud Safari, where he worked on neural architecture search and the robustness of one-shot NAS methods. He received his M.Sc. in Computer Science from Albert-Ludwigs-Universität Freiburg in 2021, supervised by Dr. Tonmoy Saikia and Prof. Dr. Thomas Brox, and his B.E. in Computer Engineering from Vivekanand Education Society's Institute of Technology, University of Mumbai, in 2018.

His broader research interests include robustness under distribution shift, sensor and signal-processing effects on visual perception systems, and evaluation methodology for reliable machine learning. He has published at venues including ICML, ECCV, ICCV, NeurIPS, TMLR, and ICCP, and has served as a reviewer for TPAMI, Nature Scientific Reports, ICCV, ECCV, NeurIPS, ICLR, BMVC, and other venues. He was recognized as a CVPR 2025 Outstanding Reviewer and an ICLR 2025 Notable Reviewer. He has also contributed to community organization, including the 45th DAGM German Conference on Pattern Recognition 2023, serving as Publicity Chair for GCPR 2025, and co-organizing the Learning to Sense workshop at NeurIPS 2025 and the AIR-FM workshop at AAAI 2026.

Jenny Schmalfuss, **Research Scientist, NVIDIA, Santa Clara, USA.**
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Jenny Schmalfuss is a Research Scientist at NVIDIA, Santa Clara, USA. Before joining NVIDIA, she was a doctoral researcher in the Computer Vision Group at the University of Stuttgart, advised by Prof. Andrés Bruhn, and a scholar of the International Max Planck Research School for Intelligent Systems (IMPRS-IS). She received her M.Sc. and B.Sc. degrees in Simulation Technology from the University of Stuttgart and worked as a research intern at the National University of Singapore and the University of Houston.

Her research is directly aligned with RoCo-Spring and focuses on the robustness, evaluation, and benchmarking of dense correspondence methods under adversarial attacks and distribution shifts. She is one of the core contributors to Spring, the high-resolution benchmark for optical flow, scene flow, and stereo, and to RobustSpring, which extends this setting to time-, stereo-, and depth-consistent corruptions for robustness evaluation. She has also made major contributions to adversarial robustness for optical flow, including perturbation-constrained attacks, adversarial weather-based attacks, and analyses of failure modes of detection-based defenses. These works provide a central foundation for the scientific motivation of RoCo-Spring: moving correspondence evaluation beyond clean accuracy toward reliable performance under realistic visual perturbations.

She has published at leading computer vision venues including CVPR, ECCV, ICCV, ICLR, TMLR and WACV. Her work on adversarial robustness for optical flow received an ECCV oral presentation, an ECCV 2022 AROW Best Paper Award and an ICVSS 2023 Outstanding Presentation award. She has regularly reviewed for top-tier conferences and journals, including CVPR, NeurIPS, ECCV, ICCV, ICLR and WACV, and received an CVPR 2025 Outstanding Reviewer recognition. She has further served in selection committees for W3 and Junior Professorships at the University of Stuttgart, and co-organized the AIR-FM workshop at AAAI 2026. For RoCo-Spring, she contributes deep expertise in Spring, RobustSpring, optical flow robustness, benchmark design, evaluation protocols, and the connection between academic correspondence research and industrial deployment needs.

Victor Oei, **Doctoral Researcher, University of Stuttgart, Germany.**
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Victor Oei is a Ph.D. student in the Collaborative Artificial Intelligence group at the Institute for Visualisation and Interactive Systems, University of Stuttgart, and a Ph.D. scholar in the International Max Planck Research School for Intelligent Systems (IMPRS-IS) since May 2025. He holds Bachelor's and Master's degrees in Simulation Technology from the University of Stuttgart, and has been a visiting student at Aalto University and ETH Zurich. His research lies at the intersection of computer vision and Theory of Mind, with a focus on building vision systems that can reason about human mental states and generalize across real-world conditions.

His expertise is directly relevant to RoCo-Spring through his work on RobustSpring, which benchmarks robustness to image corruptions for optical flow, scene flow, and stereo. In this work, he contributed to the central evaluation setting used by the challenge: testing dense correspondence methods under realistic corruptions while preserving time, stereo, and depth consistency. This background makes him especially well-suited to support the benchmark design, evaluation protocol, data handling, and participant-facing documentation for the competition.

Beyond dense correspondence, his research on robust ad-hoc teamwork and collaborative artificial intelligence reflects a broader interest in robustness, generalization, and reliable decision-making in real-world interactive settings. He has also contributed to teaching in computer vision, machine perception, imaging science, and collaborative artificial intelligence at the University of Stuttgart. For RoCo-Spring, he contributes expertise in RobustSpring, robustness evaluation for correspondence methods, benchmark design, and the connection between visual robustness and real-world generalization.

Katrin Bauer, **Doctoral Researcher, University of Stuttgart, Germany.**
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Katrin Bauer is a Ph.D. student, advised by Prof. Andrés Bruhn, in the Computer Vision group at the Institute for Visualisation and Interactive Systems, University of Stuttgart. Since March 2026, she is a Ph.D. scholar at the International Max Planck Research School for Intelligent Systems. She holds a B.Sc. and M.Sc. degree in Computer Science from the University of Stuttgart.

Her research interest directly aligns with RoCo-Spring and is focussed on analyzing and improving the robustness of methods for optical flow. She is first author of an ICCV workshop paper which analyzes the generalization capabilities of a wide range of optical flow estimators to different datasets unseen during training. Her broader research interests include robustness evaluation to distribution shifts as well as applying foundation models and unsupervised learning to optical flow.

She has served as a reviewer for the AIR-FM workshop at AAAI 2026. For RoCo-Spring, she contributes expertise in optical flow robustness and benchmark design.

Henrique Morimitsu, **Lecturer, University of Science and Technology Beijing, China.**
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Henrique Morimitsu is a Lecturer at the School of Computer and Communication Engineering, University of Science and Technology Beijing, and a member of the PRIR lab, where he works with Prof. Xiaobin Zhu and Prof. Xu-Cheng Yin. His research focuses on computer vision and deep learning, with a particular emphasis on video motion estimation, optical flow, object tracking, and the development of efficient and cost-effective correspondence methods. He received his Ph.D. and M.Sc. in Computer Science from the University of São Paulo.

His expertise is directly central to RoCo-Spring through both method development and reproducible evaluation infrastructure. He has contributed several recent optical flow methods, including DPFlow, RAPIDFlow, and RPKFlow, which target adaptive, efficient, and recurrent optical flow estimation. He also maintains PTLFlow, a PyTorch Lightning platform for training and evaluating state-of-the-art optical flow models. This makes his role especially important for RoCo-Spring, where the participant-facing codebase, standardized training and evaluation scripts, and reproducible submission workflow are critical to making the challenge accessible and fair.

Beyond optical flow, his background includes object tracking, efficient visual descriptors, and applied computer vision systems. His prior experience spans academia and applied research, including

postdoctoral positions at the University of São Paulo, INRIA, and Tsinghua University, as well as industrial computer vision work before joining USTB. He has served as a reviewer for TIP, TCSVT, ICCV, ECCV, and AAAI, and he was recognized as a CVPR 2025 Outstanding Reviewer. For RoCo-Spring, he contributes deep expertise in efficient optical flow methods, PTLFlow-based infrastructure, reproducible benchmarking, and participant-facing challenge implementation.

Andrés Bruhn, **Professor and Chair for Intelligent Systems, Head of the Computer Vision Group, University of Stuttgart, Germany.**
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Andrés Bruhn is a full professor of computer science and the Chair for Intelligent Systems at the University of Stuttgart, Germany, where he leads the Computer Vision group at the Institute for Visualization and Interactive Systems (VIS). He received a diploma degree in Computer Engineering from the University of Mannheim (2001) and a Ph.D. degree in Computer Science from Saarland University, Saarbrücken (2006). After working as a postdoctoral researcher (2006-2007) he was associated as an assistant professor at Saarland University, Saarbrücken (2007-2012). During this time he spent two months as a visiting researcher at the University of Las Palmas in Gran Canaria, Spain (2009) and built up an independent research group on Vision and Image Processing within the Cluster of Excellence "Multimodal Computing and Interaction" (2010-2012).

His research interests include various areas in the field of computer vision and image processing such as motion estimation, 3D reconstruction, image enhancement and compression as well as video conversion, taking a holistic view on accuracy, efficiency and robustness. In these fields he published over 100 refereed papers, many of them at top-tier conferences and journals such as CVPR, ICCV, ECCV, ICLR, IJCV, TMLR, TIP and TOG. These publications received several awards, among them the 2004 ECCV Best Paper Award, the 2006 DAGM German Pattern Recognition Award (Olympus Prize), the 2006 GI Outstanding Dissertation Award, the 2010 DAGM Best Paper Award and the 2014 ECCV Koenderink Prize for fundamental contributions in computer vision. Further achievements include top ranks at different vision challenges, such as winning the ECCV 2022 Robust Vision Challenge with the high-resolution multi-scale optical flow approach MS-RAFT+, and the release of community benchmarks such as Spring and RobustSpring for measuring both the accuracy and the robustness of optical flow, stereo and scene flow methods.

Andrés Bruhn served as general chair for GCPR 2018, as program chair for GCPR 2026, as area chair for ECCV 2024 and CVPR 2026, and on the program committee or as reviewer for numerous international conferences such as CVPR, ICCV, ECCV, WACV, BMVC, SIGGRAPH and SIGGRAPH Asia. Moreover, he reviewed for all major computer vision and image processing journals including TPAMI, IJCV, CVIU, TIP and TMI as well as for various international founding organizations. For his service to the community, he received several Outstanding Reviewer Awards as well as an Outstanding Area Chair Award at ECCV 2024, where he also co-chaired the oral session on adversarial learning and privacy. Beyond his service as general chair, program chair and area chair, he also organized tutorials at ICCV and GCPR as well as international Dagstuhl Seminars on efficient algorithms for computer vision and on vision for autonomous systems and probes. Moreover, he is founding faculty member of the International Max Planck Research School for Intelligent Systems (IMPRS-IS) and Steering Committee member of the Collaborative Research Center SFB-TRR161 on quantitative methods for visual computing. For RoCo-Spring, he provides senior scientific guidance on robust motion estimation, evaluation protocols and benchmark design.

Margret Keuper, **Professor and Chair for Machine Learning, University of Mannheim, and Research Group Leader, Max Planck Institute for Informatics, Germany.**
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Margret Keuper is a full professor and Chair for Machine Learning with a focus on computer vision at the University of Mannheim. She is also an affiliated research leader heading the Robust Visual Learning Group at the Max Planck Institute for Informatics in Saarbrücken. She received her Ph.D. in Computer Science from Albert-Ludwigs-Universität Freiburg under the supervision of Prof. Dr. Thomas Brox, followed by postdoctoral work in Freiburg and a visiting researcher position at the Max Planck Institute for Informatics with Prof. Bernt Schiele. She later served as Junior Professor at the University of Mannheim and as Professor of Visual Computing at the University of Siegen before returning to Mannheim. She joined ELLIS as a member in 2022 and became an ELLIS Fellow in 2024.

Her research focuses on machine learning for computer vision, with particular emphasis on robustness, generalization, reliable dense prediction, neural architecture design, and graph-based representations for visual understanding. Her expertise is directly relevant to RoCo-Spring through her contributions to optical flow and robust vision, including FlowNet2, one of the landmark deep optical flow estimation methods, and FlowBench, which benchmarks the reliability and generalization of optical flow estimation methods. Her group has also contributed broadly to robustness benchmarking, adversarial robustness, and evaluation methodology for vision models.

She leads an internationally visible research group that regularly publishes at top computer vision and machine learning venues, including TPAMI, CVPR, ICCV, ECCV, AAAI, NeurIPS, ICLR, ICML, and TMLR. She regularly serves the community as a reviewer and area chair for major venues, including CVPR, ICCV, ECCV, WACV, NeurIPS, ICLR, ICML, and related conferences. She has substantial experience in scientific organization, including serving as Tutorial Chair at ECAI 2024, co-session chair for the ICCV 2023 oral session on adversarial robustness, Program Chair for GCPR 2025, and co-organizer of workshops, including Learning to Sense at NeurIPS 2025 and AIR-FM at AAAI 2026. For RoCo-Spring, she provides senior scientific guidance on robust visual learning, dense correspondence evaluation, and challenge design.

A.1 List of Tentative Program Committee

We will use OpenReview to manage workshop paper submissions, reviewer assignment, discussion, and author notifications. Each submission will receive exactly three reviews, and we will cap reviewer load at no more than three assigned papers per reviewer.

Given that the paper submissions are coming from the challenge, the identity of authors for most tracks is already known via the public leaderboard, thus all reviewing will be single-blind.

The following is the tentative list of reviewers confirmed so far. We will continue to expand this list through an open call for reviewers after acceptance to ensure broad expertise across optical flow, stereo, scene flow, robustness, benchmarking, and reliable visual perception.

1. Noah Berenguel Senn, University of Stuttgart
2. Alex Heller, University of Stuttgart
3. Fabio Tosi, University of Bologna
4. Bartolomei Luca, University of Bologna
5. Simon Kiefhaber, University of Darmstadt
6. Christoph Reich, University of Darmstadt
7. Rene Schuster, DFKI
8. Maximilian Luz, University of Freiburg
9. Philipp Schröpel, University of Freiburg
10. David T. Hoffmann, University of Freiburg
11. Simon Schrodi, University of Freiburg
12. Alexander Auras, University of Siegen
13. Andrii Nehrych, University of Siegen
14. Michael Brilka, University of Siegen
15. Pratik Bisht, University of Siegen
16. Marina Evers, University of Siegen
17. Hendrik Sommerhoff, University of Siegen
18. Erqi Huang, University of Siegen
19. Ivo Ihrke, University of Siegen
20. Matthias Kahl, University of Siegen
21. Syed Muhammad Kazim, University of Siegen
22. Andreas Kolb, University of Siegen

23. Kostiantyn Ahapov, University of Siegen
24. Kristof van Laerhoven, University of Siegen
25. Natacha Kuete Meli, University of Siegen
26. Marius Bock, University of Siegen
27. Jannis Maron, University of Siegen
28. Onofre Martotrell, University of the Balearic Islands
29. John Meshreki, University of Siegen
30. Michael Shopf-Küster, University of Siegen
31. Patrick Müller, University of Siegen
32. Holder Nies, University of Siegen
33. Zeyneddin Oz, University of Siegen
34. Amir Peiraviminaei, University of Siegen
35. Jan Philipp Schneider, University of Siegen
36. Mohamed Saleh, University of Siegen
37. Somesh Salunkhe, University of Siegen
38. Katrin Schnieber, University of Siegen
39. Aryaman Sharma, University of Siegen
40. Daniel Stock, University of Siegen
41. Lorena Stracke, University of Siegen
42. Anna Katharina Wigger, University of Siegen
43. Qiushuang Zhang, University of Siegen
44. Volker Blanz, University of Siegen
45. Katharina Prasse, University of Mannheim
46. Mishal Fatima, University of Mannheim
47. Tejaswini Medi, University of Mannheim
48. Steffen Jung, University of Mannheim
49. Kanchana Vaishnavi Gandikota, University of Siegen
50. Yushi Liu, Bosch Center for AI
51. Yuxuan Zhou, ERNIE Team, Baidu
52. Jiawen Xu, TU Berlin
53. Selim Kuzucu, MPI for Informatics
54. Ada Görgün, MPI for Informatics
55. Siddhartha Gairola, MPI for Informatics and IST Austria
56. Robin Hesse, MPI for Informatics
57. Gabi Kadlecová, Distill Labs
58. Jovita Lukasik, University of Siegen
59. Harsh Rangwani, Adobe Research
60. Naman Deep Singh, University of Tübingen
61. Christoph Leiter, University of Mannheim
62. Anna Kukleva, Meta